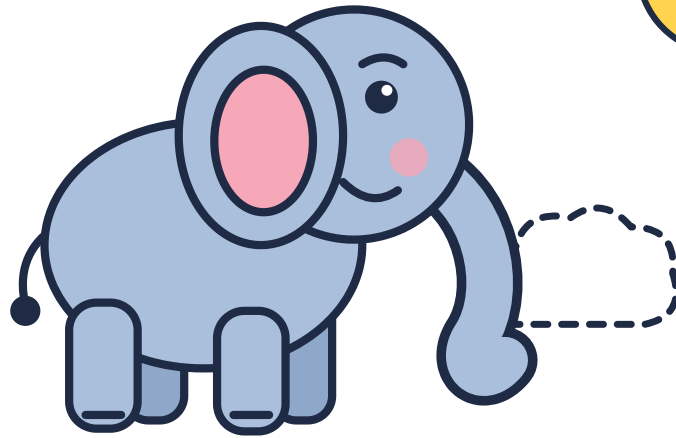
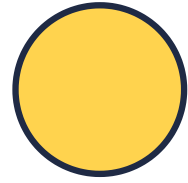
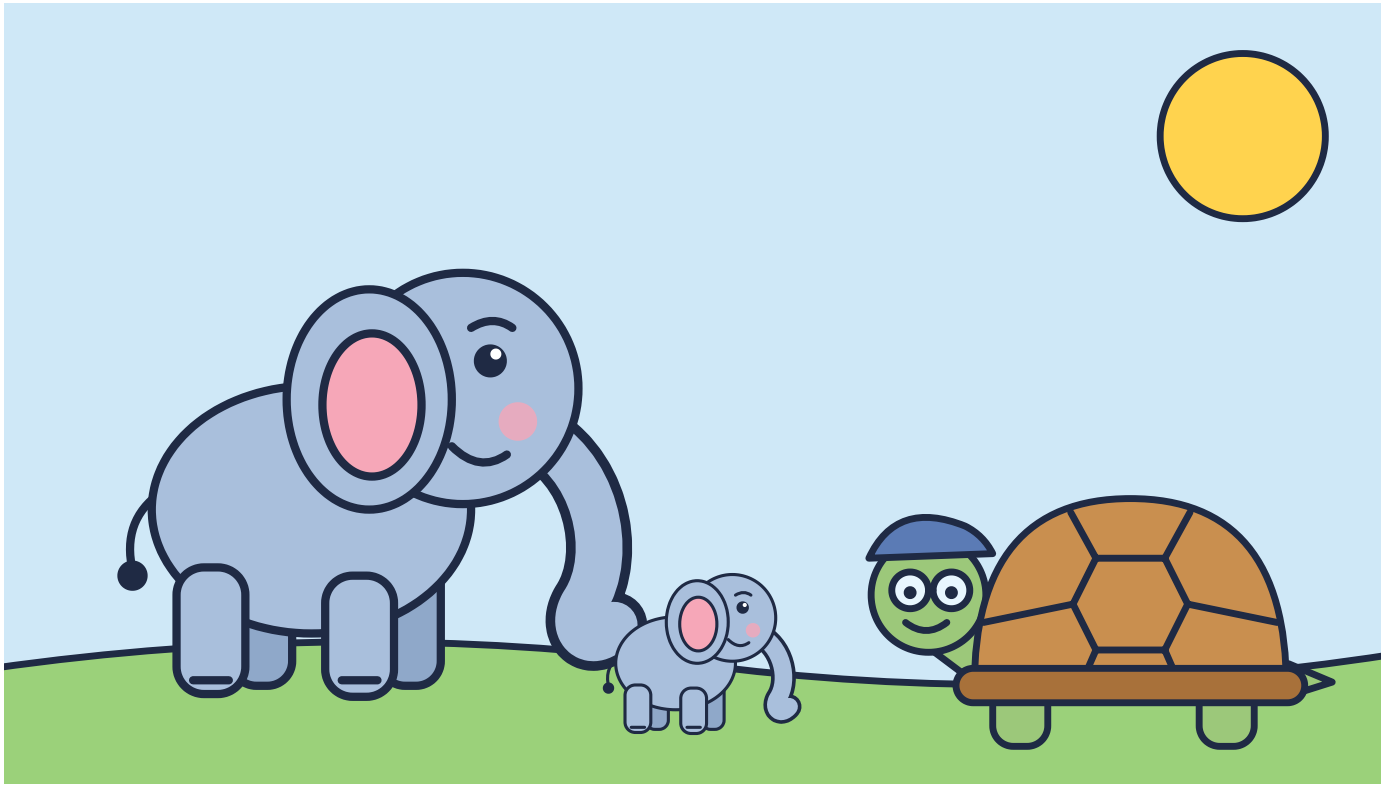




Ellie's **Tickly** Trunk

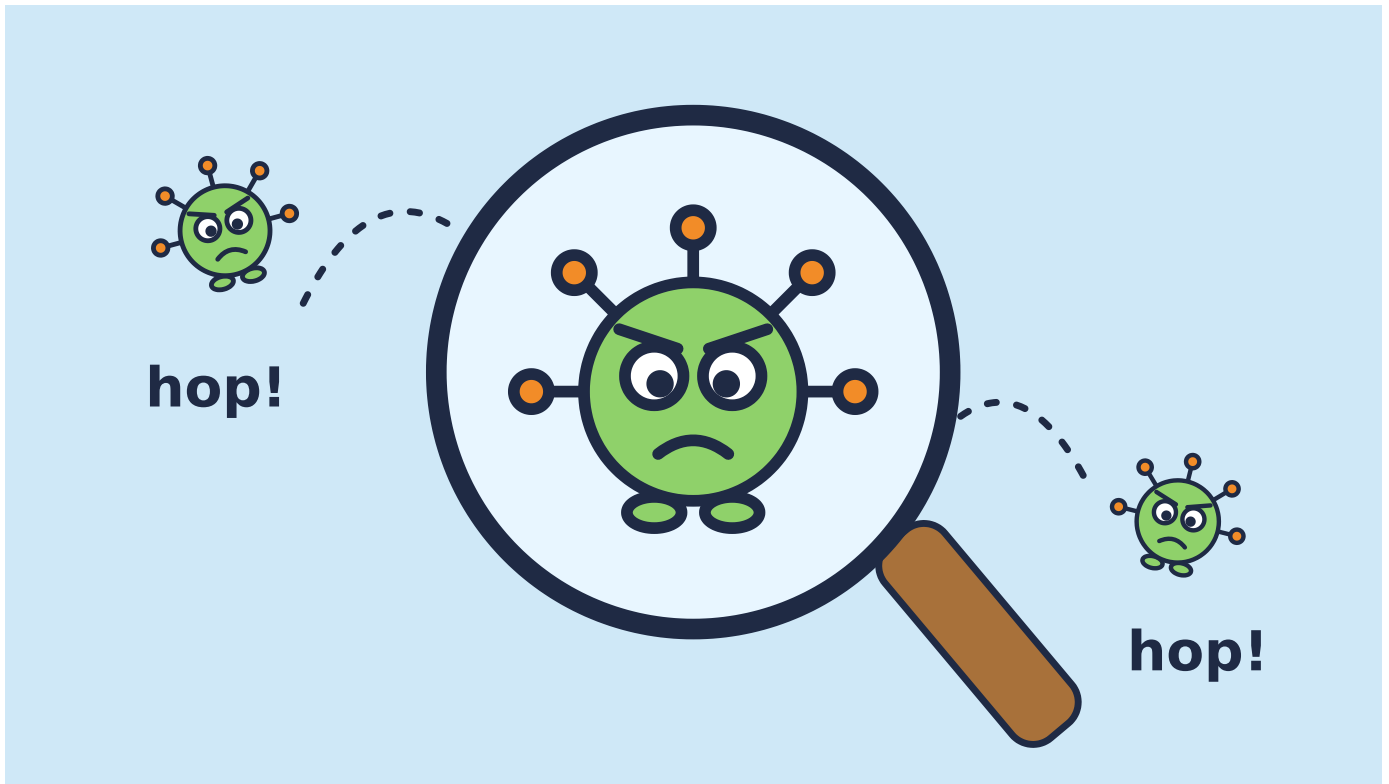
A story about the flu spray, and keeping everybody safe



This is Ellie. Ellie is an elephant.

She has big flappy ears, a waggly tail and a very, very, **very** long nose. It's called a trunk.

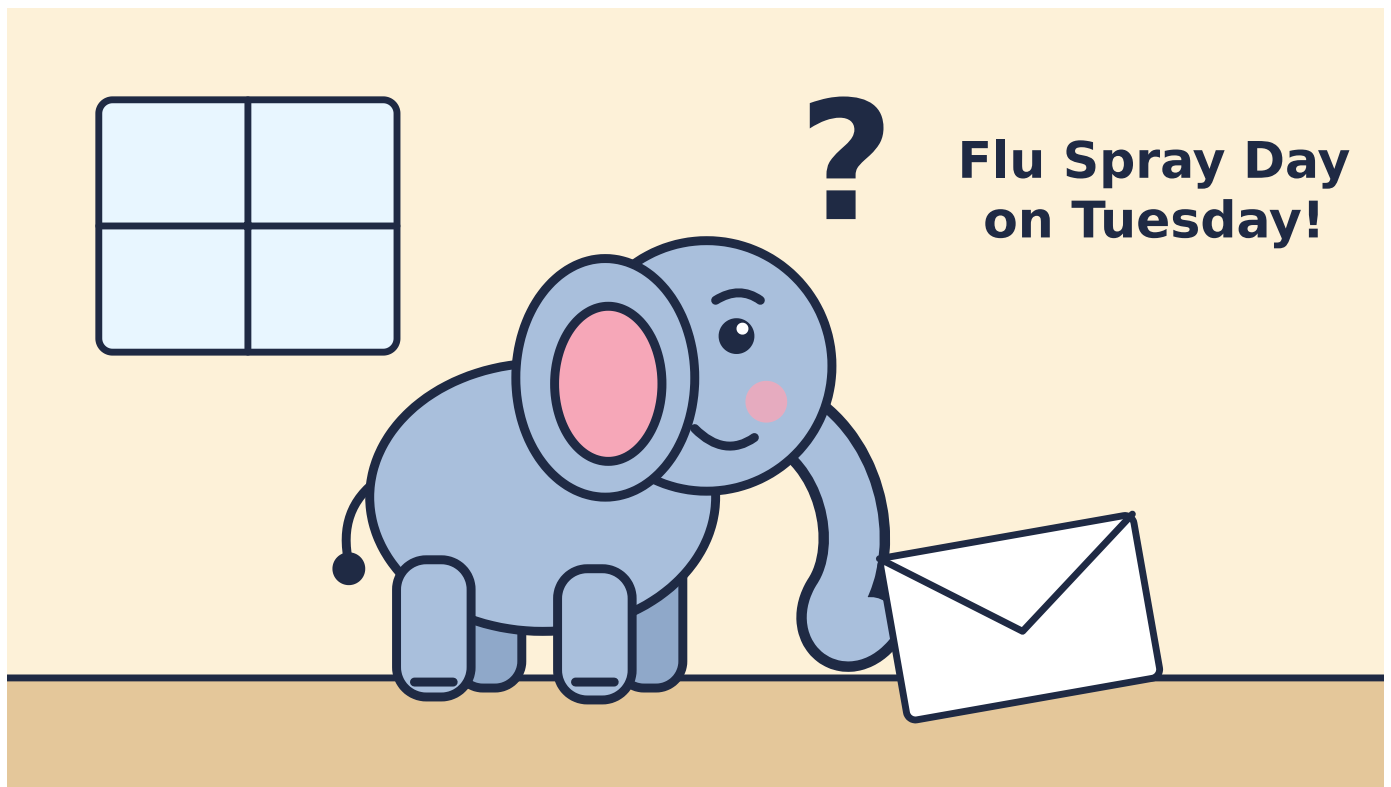
Ellie lives with Mum and her baby brother, Pip. Next door lives Grandad Tortoise. He is 102 years old. He is very slow, very wise, and he makes the best jam sandwiches in Sunny Lane.



But in Sunny Lane lived some little troublemakers. The **Flu Bugs!**

Flu Bugs are too tiny to see. They love hopping from nose to nose. If they get in, they make you hot, achy, sneezy and very tired.

Most children feel better in about a week. But babies, grandads and grannies can get really, really poorly.

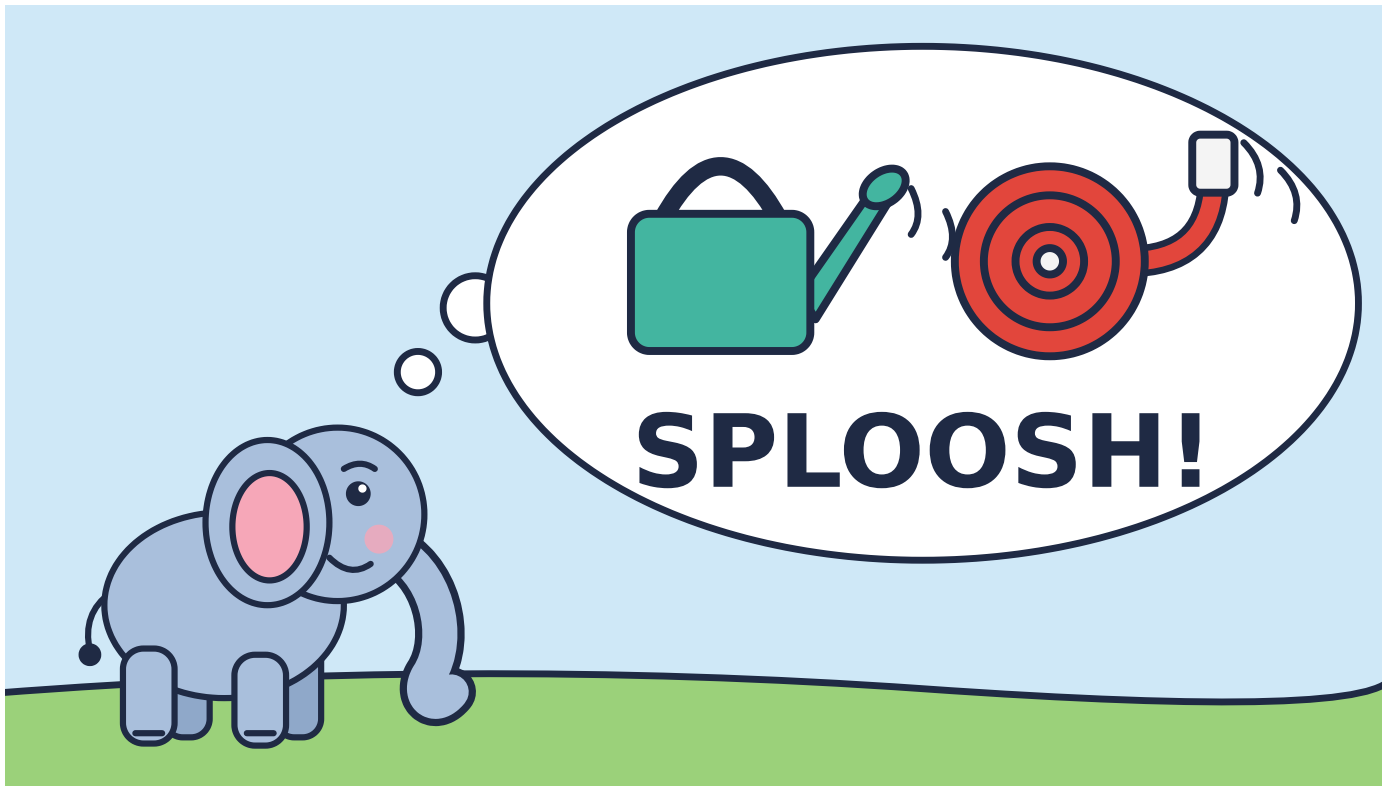


One day, Ellie brought a letter home from school.

"It's Flu Spray Day on Tuesday!" said Mum.

Ellie's ears drooped. "Is it a needle?" she whispered.

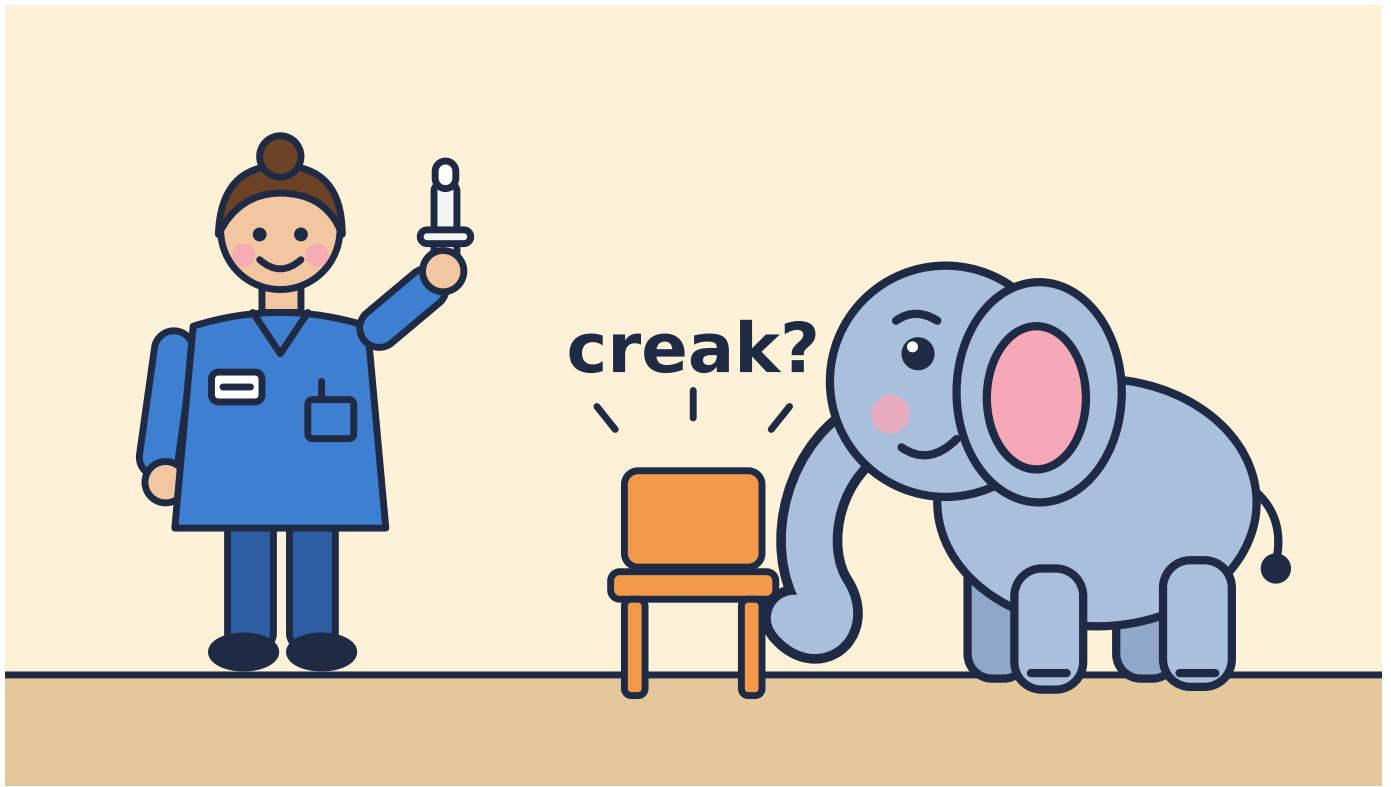
"No," said Mum. "It's a tiny squirt up your nose. **One squirt up each side.** That's all."



Ellie had a think. A squirt up the nose?

Would it be a **WATERING CAN**? Would it be a **FIRE HOSE**?
Ellie pictured the whole school getting soaked. SPLOOSH!

Mum laughed so much she snorted. "It's much smaller than that," she said. "It's like a teeny puff of mist."

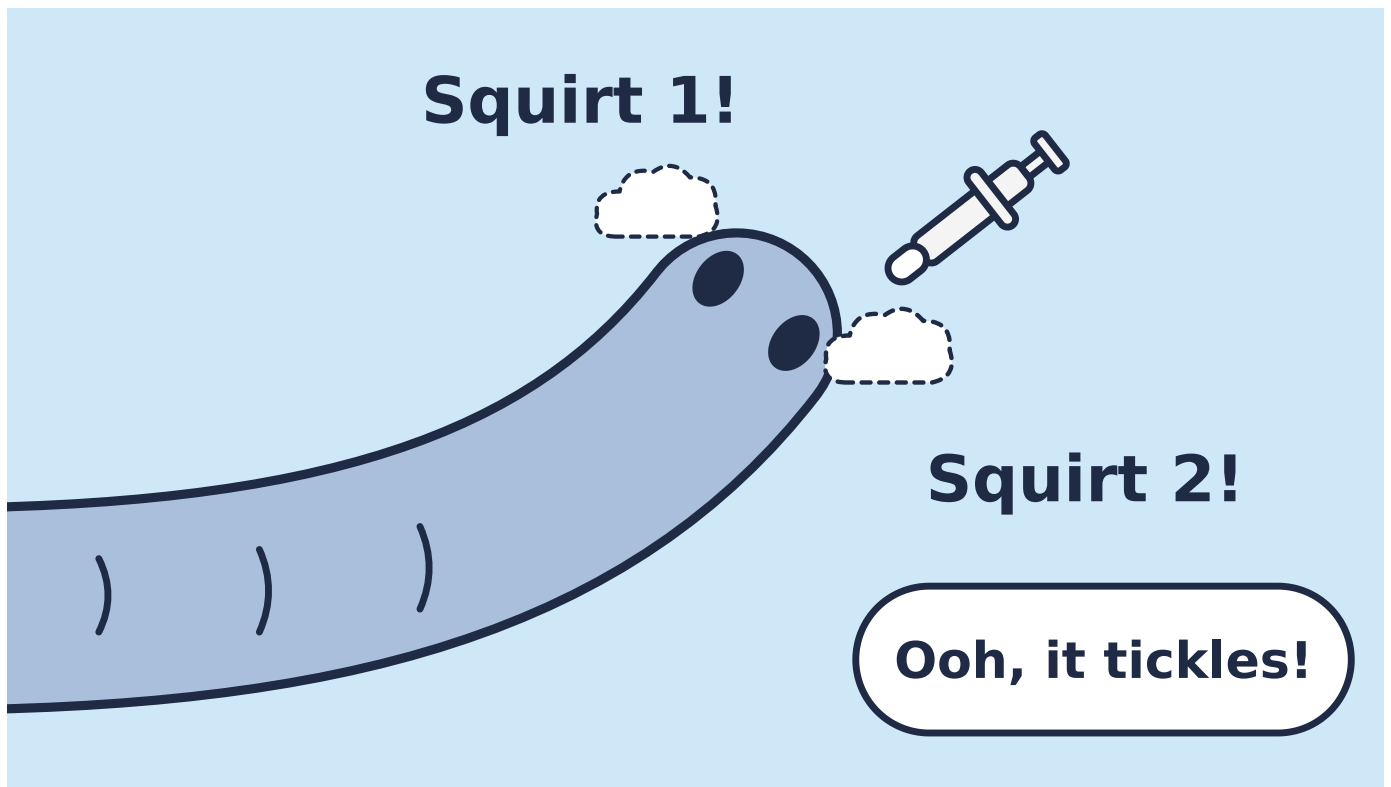


On Tuesday, Nurse Lou came to school with a big smile and a box of little sprays.

"Sit on the chair," she said. "Just breathe normally. You don't need to sniff."

Ellie looked at the chair. The chair looked at Ellie. She sat down very, very carefully.

CRREEEAK!

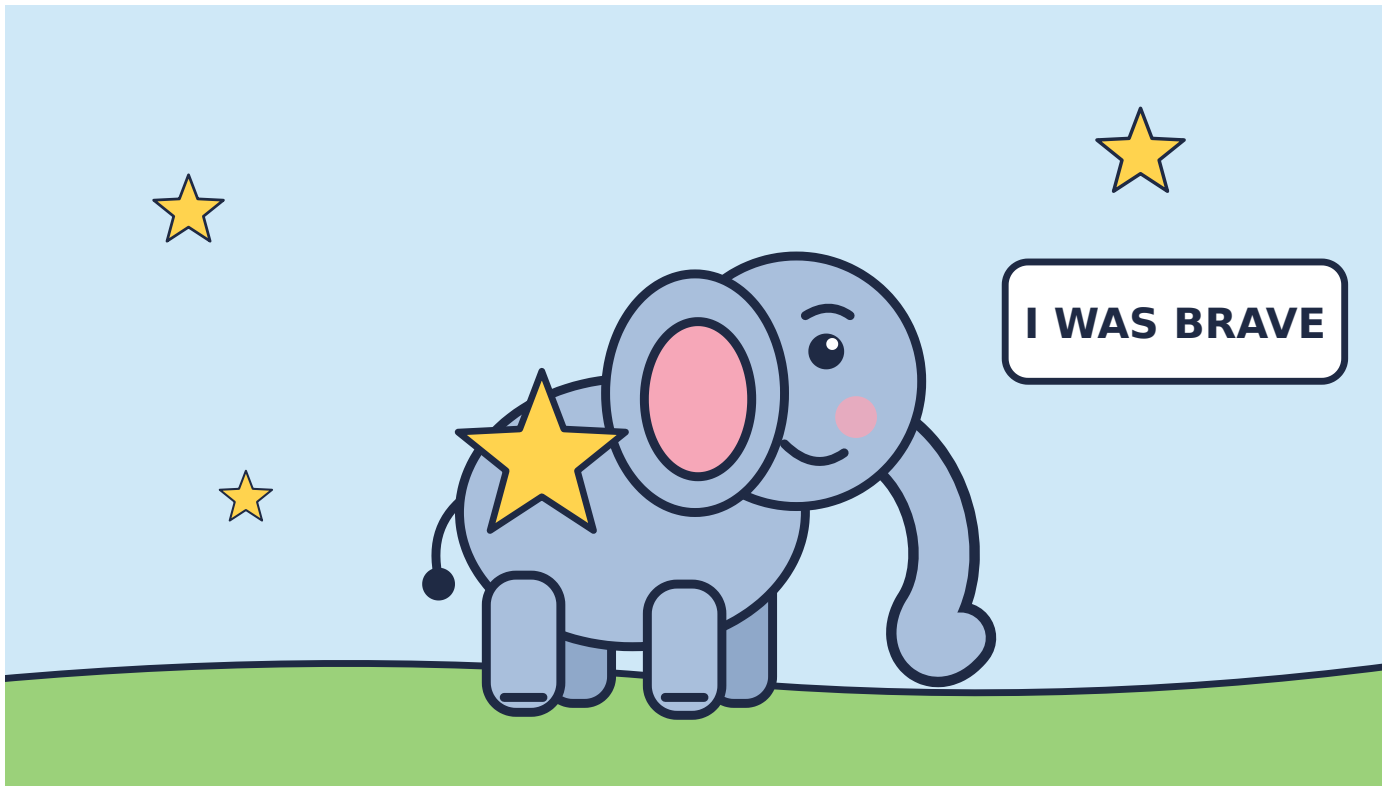


Nurse Lou looked at Ellie's trunk. She looked all the way down it. Then all the way back up again.

"Goodness me," she said. "That's the longest nose in the whole school!" Everyone giggled. Even Ellie.

Squirt! Up one side. **Squirt!** Up the other side.

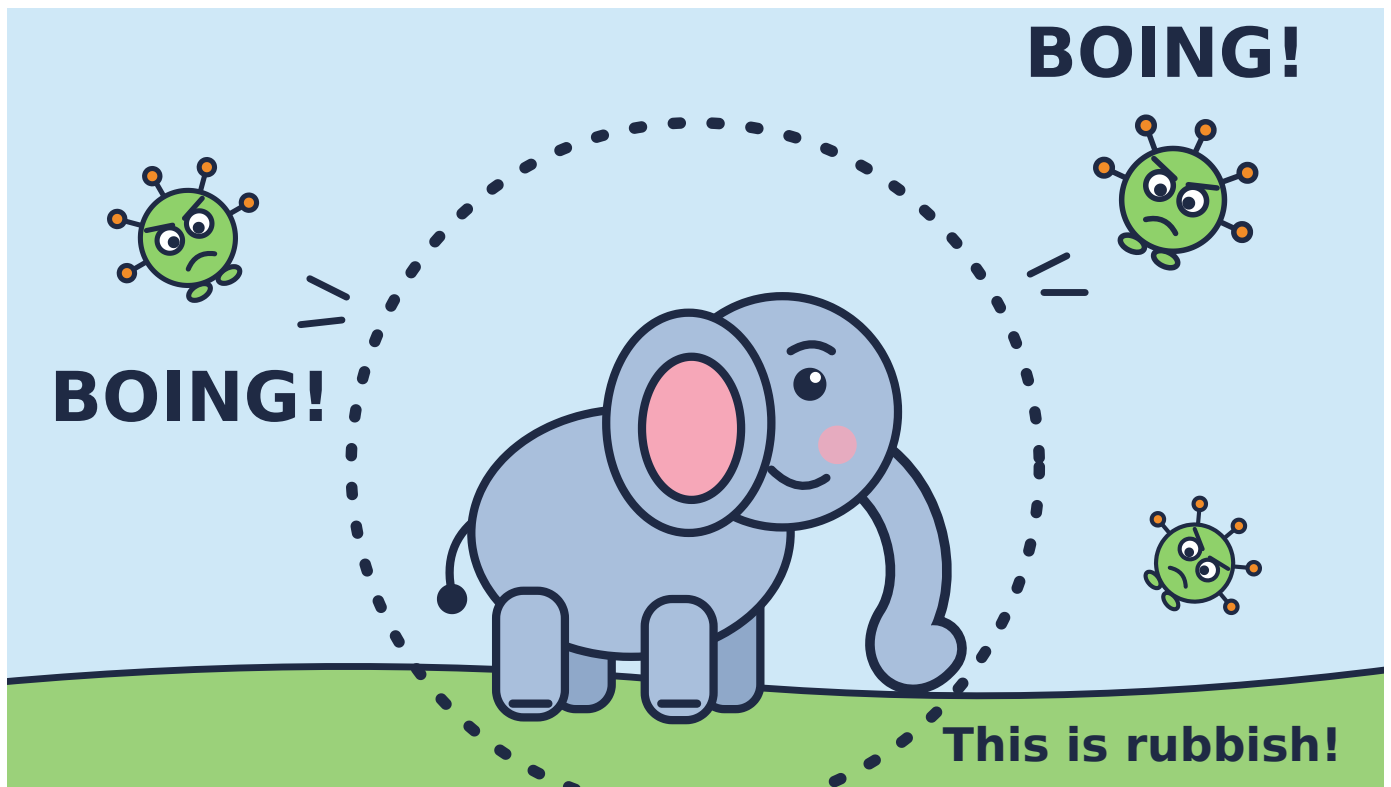
"Ooh, that tickles!" said Ellie. And that was it. All done.



Ellie got a shiny sticker. It said **I WAS BRAVE**.

Her trunk felt a bit tickly and runny for a day. That's OK. It soon stopped.

Ellie wore her sticker to bed. And to breakfast. And in the bath. (It fell off in the bath.)

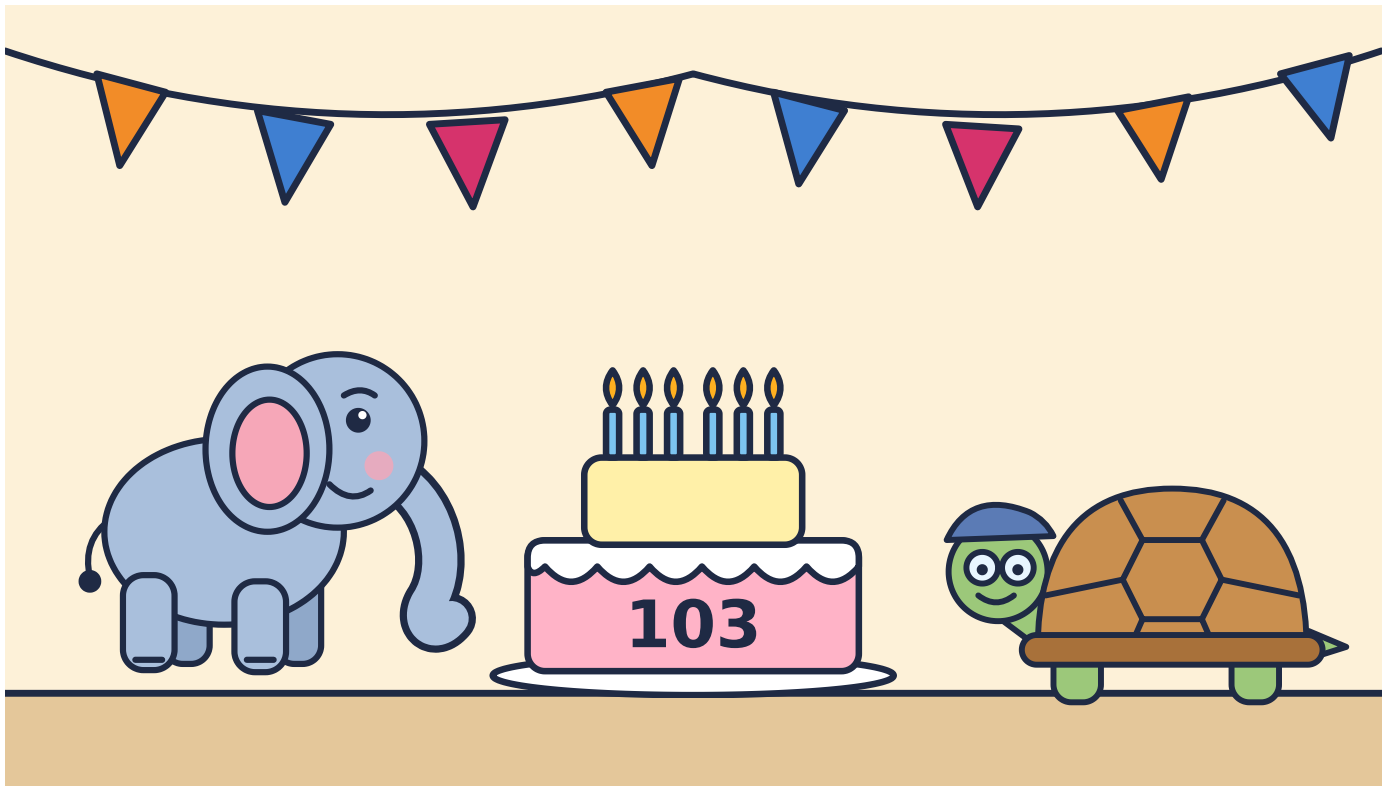


That week, the Flu Bugs came hopping down Sunny Lane.

They tried to jump up Ellie's trunk. **BOING!** They bounced right off.

They tried all her friends at school. **BOING! BOING! BOING!** Everyone had had their flu spray.

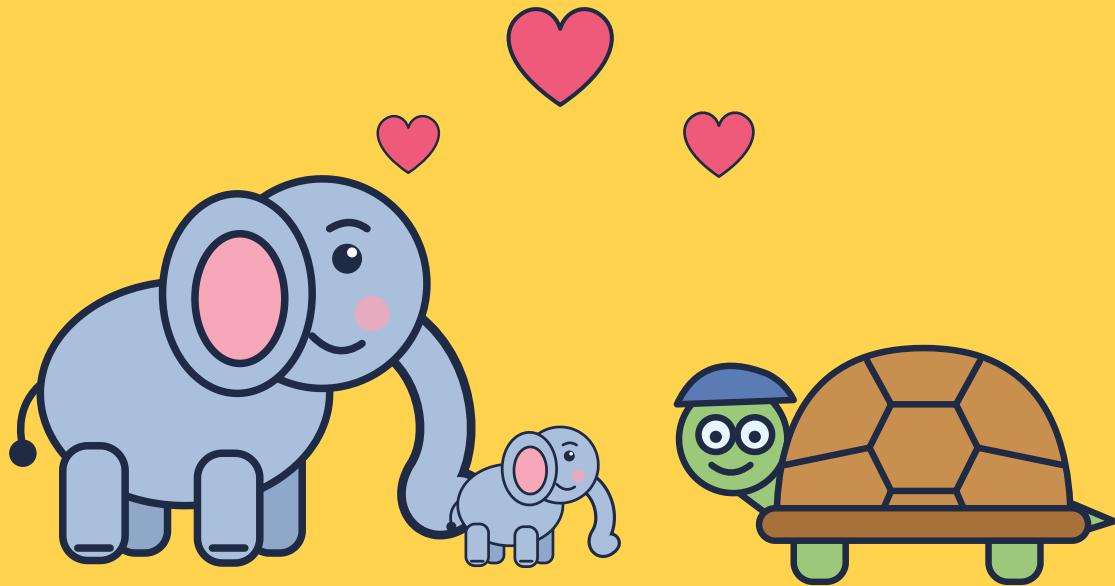
The Flu Bugs couldn't get to baby Pip. They couldn't get to Grandad Tortoise. "This is rubbish," they grumbled, and off they went.



On Saturday it was Grandad Tortoise's birthday. He was 103!

Nobody was poorly, so everybody came to the party.

There were 103 candles on the cake. Grandad Tortoise blew and blew and blew. It took him until teatime.



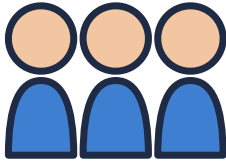
A little tickle for me keeps everybody safe.

Having your flu spray is a small, brave thing. It helps keep your friends, your family, the babies and the grandads and grannies safe from flu too.

What happens on Flu Spray Day

Read this together before the day. You can point at each picture as you go.

1



Wait for your turn

2



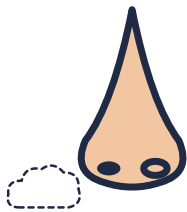
Sit on the chair

3



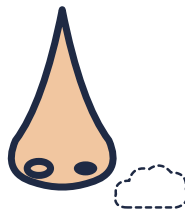
**Breathe normally.
No big sniff.**

4



**A squirt up one
side**

5



**A squirt up the
other side**

6



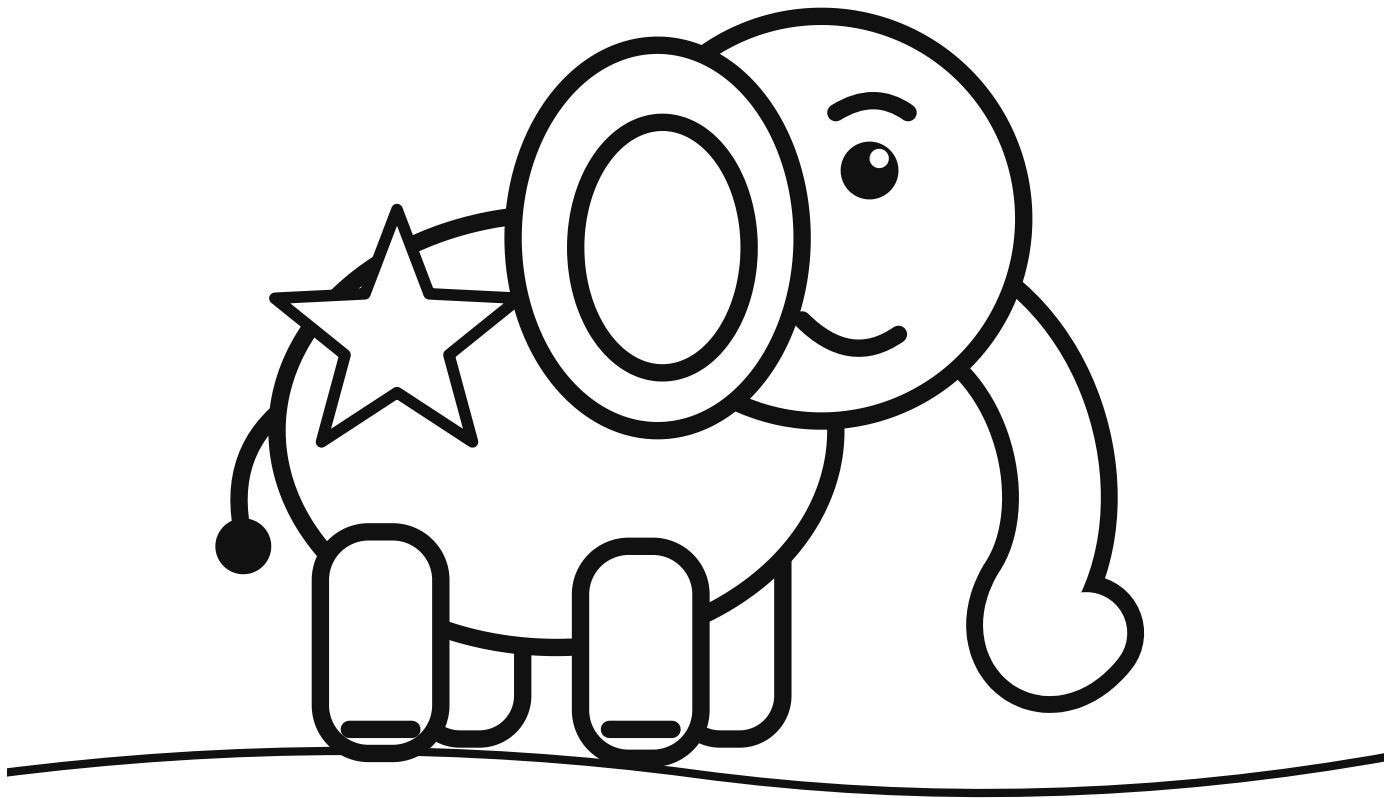
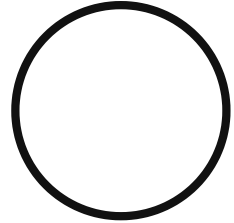
**All done! Sticker
time.**

It might feel cold and tickly. That's OK. Some children have their flu vaccine as a little injection instead. That's OK too. It keeps everyone safe in just the same way.

Colour me in!

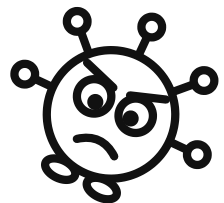
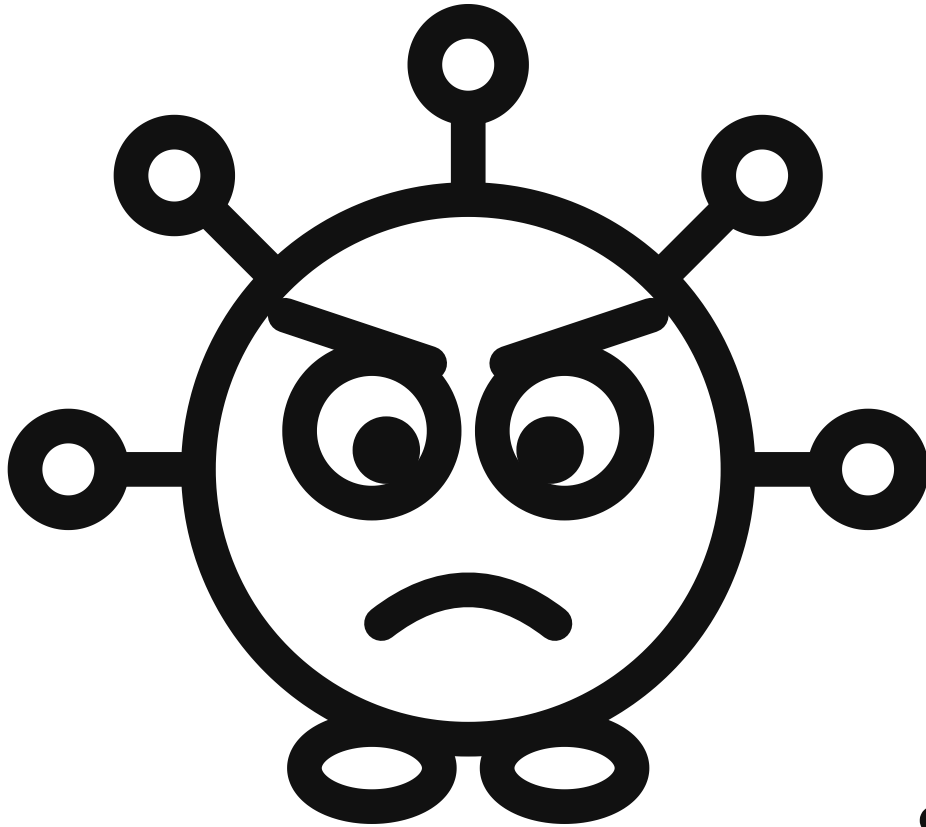
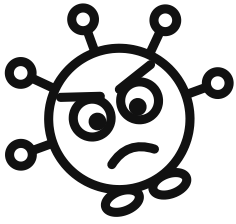
Five pictures to colour. Print them out, or colour them on a tablet.

Ellie was brave!



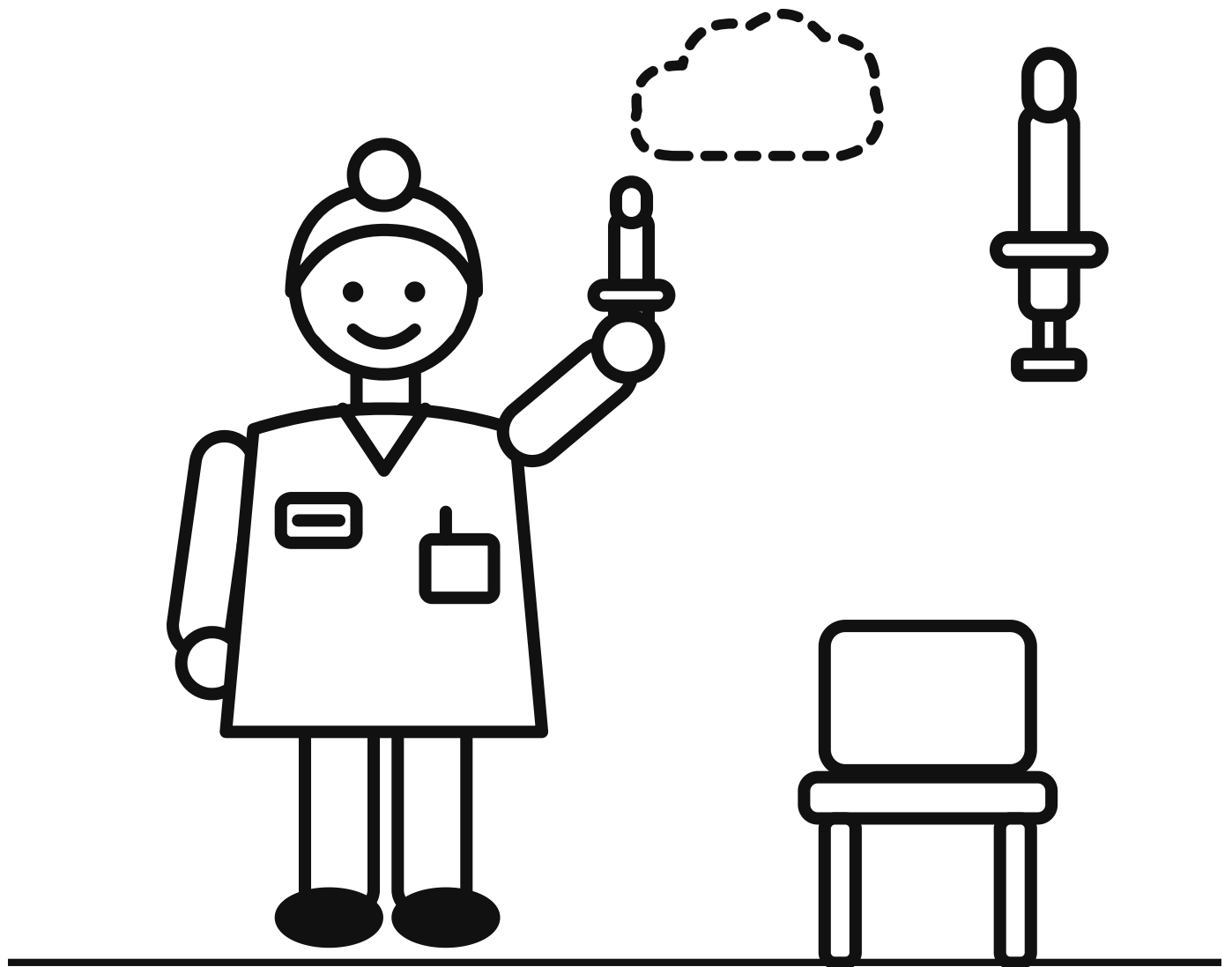
My name is _____

BOING! Off you go, Flu Bug!



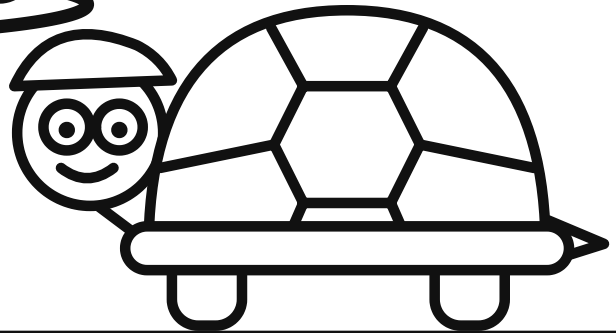
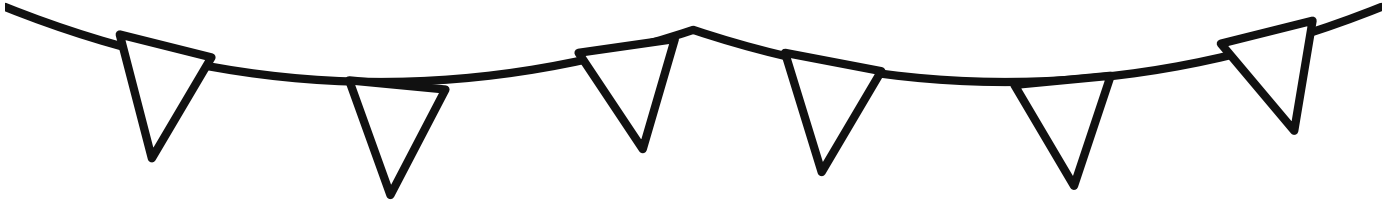
My name is _____

Nurse Lou and the tiny spray



My name is _____

**Happy 103rd birthday,
Grandad Tortoise!**



My name is _____

I had my flu spray!



My name is _____

For grown-ups

- The children's flu vaccine is a nasal spray: one spray into each nostril. It's quick and doesn't hurt. Your child doesn't need to sniff.
- Afterwards some children get a runny or blocked nose, a headache, tiredness or a smaller appetite for a short time.
- Some children are offered an injection instead, for example if the nasal spray isn't suitable for them.
- Vaccinating children lowers their chance of getting flu and helps stop it spreading to babies, older people and people with long-term conditions. It doesn't guarantee a child won't catch flu.
- For children with additional needs: read the story a few times before the day, practise sitting on a chair and breathing normally, and let school know what helps your child feel calm.
- Questions? Ask the school immunisation team, your GP practice or a pharmacist.